2 Up and running

This chapter covers

- Defining an actor and its behavior
- Instantiating and sending messages to an actor
- Keeping state in the actor with a variable
- Keeping state in the actor with its behavior
- Scheduling sending a message

This chapter covers in practice the basic parts of Akka from the previous chapter: creating an actor, sending messages to actors, and setting actors' behavior. It also explains how to handle state and send messages with a scheduled delay.

Without further ado, let's start with a minimal Akka application: a wallet into which you can deposit money. This can be part of a larger application that handles betting on sports events with money from the wallet. You learn how to create such a betting application later in this book, but first you need to learn some basics.

NOTE To run the examples in this book, follow the instructions in appendix A to install all the tools. When you've finished the installation, return here and get started.

In this chapter, you get to know different variants of such a wallet, which will guide you through some Akka primitives:

- At first, the wallet's only function is to print the deposited money to the console without keeping track of the total amount.